Theory case · Topic 1 · 2 points · 15 min

## C03 — Atlas Line Maintenance: the four stages of the management process in a ramp-up

*Atlas Line Maintenance S.L. has won a contract to perform the overnight checks of a low-cost airline at a new base. The station manager, Marta, has six months to be ready. She sets the goal of "zero technical delays in the first summer" and a plan to hire and certify 25 mechanics. She draws the shift structure and decides who is responsible for each aircraft type and which tools each shift needs. During the first weeks she holds daily briefings, encourages the team and mediates a conflict between the night and day shifts over handovers. Every Friday she compares the delays and the hours per check with the targets and adjusts the shifts.*

### Part (a) · 1.25 points

*Identify the four stages of the management process in Marta's actions*

| Stage [Slide 14] | Content | At Atlas |
|---|---|---|
| **Planning** | Defining goals, establishing strategy, developing subplans | "Zero technical delays"; plan to hire and certify 25 mechanics |
| **Organizing** | What must be done, how, and by whom | Shift structure, responsibilities per aircraft type, tools per shift |
| **Leading** | Directing and motivating, resolving conflicts | Daily briefings, encouragement, mediation between shifts |
| **Controlling** | Monitoring that activities go as planned | Friday comparison of delays and hours per check with the targets |

KEY POINTS

- Planning: the zero-delay goal and the hiring and certification plan.
- Organizing: shift structure, responsibilities, tools.
- Leading: daily briefings, motivation, resolving the shift conflict.
- Controlling: weekly comparison of delays and hours with the targets.

## Part (b) · 0.75 points

*Explain why the four stages form a cycle and what Marta does when she finds a deviation*

The management process is a **cycle** around the organization's purpose [Slide 14]. Control is not the end: when the Friday review shows a deviation (for example, more hours per check than planned), Marta corrects it by **reorganizing** the shifts or by **revising the plan** (more mechanics, new targets), and she must then **lead** the team through the change. The new results are controlled the following week, so the four stages keep repeating while the base operates.

KEY POINTS

- Control results feed the next round of planning: the process is cyclical.
- A deviation triggers corrective action: reorganizing the shifts or revising the plan, then leading the change.